



Hilmar van der Veen

Senior Frontend Engineer · React and Angular · TypeScript · 10+ years



📍 Zandvoort, NL

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📅 Available immediately · 32 to 40 hours a week · freelance via Hilmar ICT Services, KVK 97564303 · Dutch (native), English (fluent)

Senior frontend engineer with 10+ years building complex, data-driven, accessible interfaces for enterprise clients, across **React and Angular**. I build scalable, maintainable component architectures where frontend and backend fit tightly together, with design systems, type-safe state (RxJS, typed GraphQL), SSR, i18n and accessibility as defaults. Comfortable end-to-end: reverse-engineering legacy systems to migrate them, shaping GraphQL contracts with backend, coordinating up to 6 teams in shared monorepos, and partnering with design and business on A/B experiments that grew GMV (winning variants up to 24%).

<> CORE SKILLS

Frameworks	React 19 · Angular (6 to 12) · Next.js / React Router (SSR)
Language and state	TypeScript · RxJS · Redux / Zustand · GraphQL (urql, gql.tada)
UI and systems	TailwindCSS / SCSS · Storybook · Web Components (Stencil) · Design systems · WCAG 2.1 / 2.2 AA accessibility · i18n · Micro-frontends
Testing	Playwright · Cypress · Jest / Vitest
Platform	Nx · Node · Docker · Kubernetes · Azure / AWS / GCP · GitLab CI / Azure DevOps · Headless CMS (Contentstack, Storyblok, Bloomreach)
Also	Kotlin / Java · C# / .NET (earlier)

🏢 EXPERIENCE

Senior Frontend Engineer · bol.com (freelance)

📅 21 Jul 2025 to 1 Oct 2026

Hybrid · React Router (Remix lineage) · GraphQL · Nx monorepo

bol.com is one of the largest e-commerce retailers in the Netherlands and Belgium. My engagement there was extended three times.

- Migrated Loyalty (**Select**) and Digital (**Kobo Plus** e-reader) pages off the legacy Java/HTML-templating webshop onto bol's new server-side-rendered React Router platform, reverse-engineering legacy Java behaviour to rebuild it faithfully (subscription page, "My Kobo Plus" page, Software and Games pages).
- Started in the **Loyalty** team: built the Select **points-overview page** end-to-end (rewards table with order-point and action-point rows, date formatting, i18n, tests and Storybook stories) and added analytics to the Select acquisition page, before moving to **Digital**.
- **Built a new app from an empty folder to production** in the Nx monorepo (SSR, routing, CI/CD, GCP/Kubernetes) and drove the phased, reversible production rollout (employees first, then ramping by percentage to 100%) from the legacy stack.
- **Shipped 9 A/B experiments** with the designer and business team, built in code and configured in the experimentation tool. Winning variants delivered **GMV uplifts of up to 24%** (roughly 5% to 24% across the winners). Not every experiment won, so the aggregate effect was positive but modest.
- Treated GraphQL as a frontend-to-backend contract (urql), reshaping API fields with backend to keep components data-driven, and contributed backend logic in **Kotlin** when capacity was tight.
- Component-driven development with Storybook, typed React with Tailwind, accessibility to WCAG 2.2 AA, and tests with Vitest/Jest, Testing Library and GraphQL mocks. Worked across up to 6 teams, aligning the GraphQL contract and reviewing changes that crossed team boundaries.

Senior Frontend Developer · Belastingdienst

📅 Jan 2023 to Dec 2024

Angular · React · Web Components (Stencil) · RxJS

- Built a greenfield low-code **visual forms editor** (drag-and-drop, conditional logic, validation, i18n), building on patterns proven on the entrepreneur portal, that let content editors and designers build, verify and demo a tax form themselves. This cut a new income-tax form from **months of engineering to a few days** and removed the constant back-and-forth with the dev team.
- Designed a JSON-configurable, data-driven **Angular component architecture** for the entrepreneur portal and drove **design-system governance** with shared Stencil Web Components that other developers inject and reuse across Angular, React and Vue, dropping new-page build time from **1 to 2 weeks to 1 to 2 days**. Improved WCAG 2.1 AA accessibility, with CI/CD via GitLab, Jenkins, Tekton, ArgoCD and test automation using Cypress and Playwright.
- Acted as the connective glue for design-system adoption: paired hands-on with developers across **multiple teams** on implementation, and worked with **Product Owners** to unblock them and speed up rolling the BOLD (Stencil) design system into their applications. Tutored a senior developer who came from JavaScript and Vue through Angular, RxJS and streams, and the proper use of services. The engagement was extended four times.

Senior Frontend Developer · Nationale Postcode Loterij

📅 Jul 2022 to Jan 2023

React · Next.js · Nx · TailwindCSS

- Built a greenfield, **JSON-driven international Design System** (Nx monorepo) with Storyblok headless CMS, Next.js SSR and WCAG 2.1 AA, cutting campaign time-to-market from weeks to a few days across European labels. AWS serverless (Python) APIs, plus Playwright/Cypress.

Senior Frontend Developer · Athlon

📅 Oct 2020 to Jul 2022

Angular 12 · RxJS · Azure DevOps

- Led migration of a legacy Angular 1.6 app to a modern Angular 12 stack: component library, dynamic dashboards, WCAG 2.1 AA, headless CMS, and CI/CD with Azure DevOps, Docker, Kubernetes. Coached junior and senior developers on Angular best practices and reviewed their code.

Senior Frontend Developer · Ortec (FedEx) and Omniplan

📅 Apr 2019 to Jul 2019 · Aug 2019 to Mar 2020

Angular · RxJS · .NET Core

- Ortec: interactive **route and geo-visualisations** with realtime updates via observables, Angular micro-frontends over .NET Core microservices. Omniplan: migrated legacy AngularJS/.NET to Angular 9 and .NET Core REST/gRPC with a modular auth/membership service.

Earlier engagements (2016 to 2019, mostly contract): Frontend Developer / UI Coach at **Randstad** (design-system components, Bloomreach), and Senior/Fullstack Developer at **Bluefield Smart Access** (React/.NET data-viz and geo dashboards for Ziggo and Tommy Hilfiger, with Neo4j and RabbitMQ), **Niped** (React and WPF health platform), **Conclusion** (Vue migration), and **Transdev** (Angular and .NET Core API layer and traveller portal).

🏢 OWN COMPANY AND PRODUCT

Hilmar ICT Services (eenmanszaak, Zandvoort): IT consultancy, web development, and maintenance of web applications. Designed, built and run a **production SEO content platform end-to-end** using Next.js, React 19, SSR, headless-CMS integration and analytics tracking, covering everything from architecture and content modelling to search-optimisation and hosting. Live demo available on request.

🎓 EDUCATION AND TERMS

BSc Physics and Astronomy, University of Amsterdam (UvA), 2012 · Young Capital Software Development traject (Scrum, C#), 2016 · online training (React, Angular, TypeScript, C#, SQL), 2020

Terms: €95 to €125 per hour, depending on project type and work (excluding VAT). Hybrid with 1 to 2 days on site, or remote.

🛡️ SECURITY AND COMPLIANCE

Completed bol's full engineer security curriculum through **Certified Secure** (live, instructor-led, hands-on hacking and secure-coding training), earning the **Essential Security**, **Essential Specialties**, **Security Specialist**, **Web Security Specialist** and **Server Security Specialist** certifications (Basic, Intermediate and Advanced levels). Also completed the hands-on **Secure Development**, **Full-Stack Security** (frontend, backend and Cloud-infrastructure vulnerabilities) and **Kubernetes / K8s internal-network security** trainings, plus **Protecting PII** (GDPR) and **EU AI Act / AI-literacy** compliance training.